

Chapter 4

System and User Preferences

This chapter covers the settings used for customizing the DaVinci Resolve environment. System Preferences govern setup options that control the hardware and software environment, while User Preferences control various user controls within the software.

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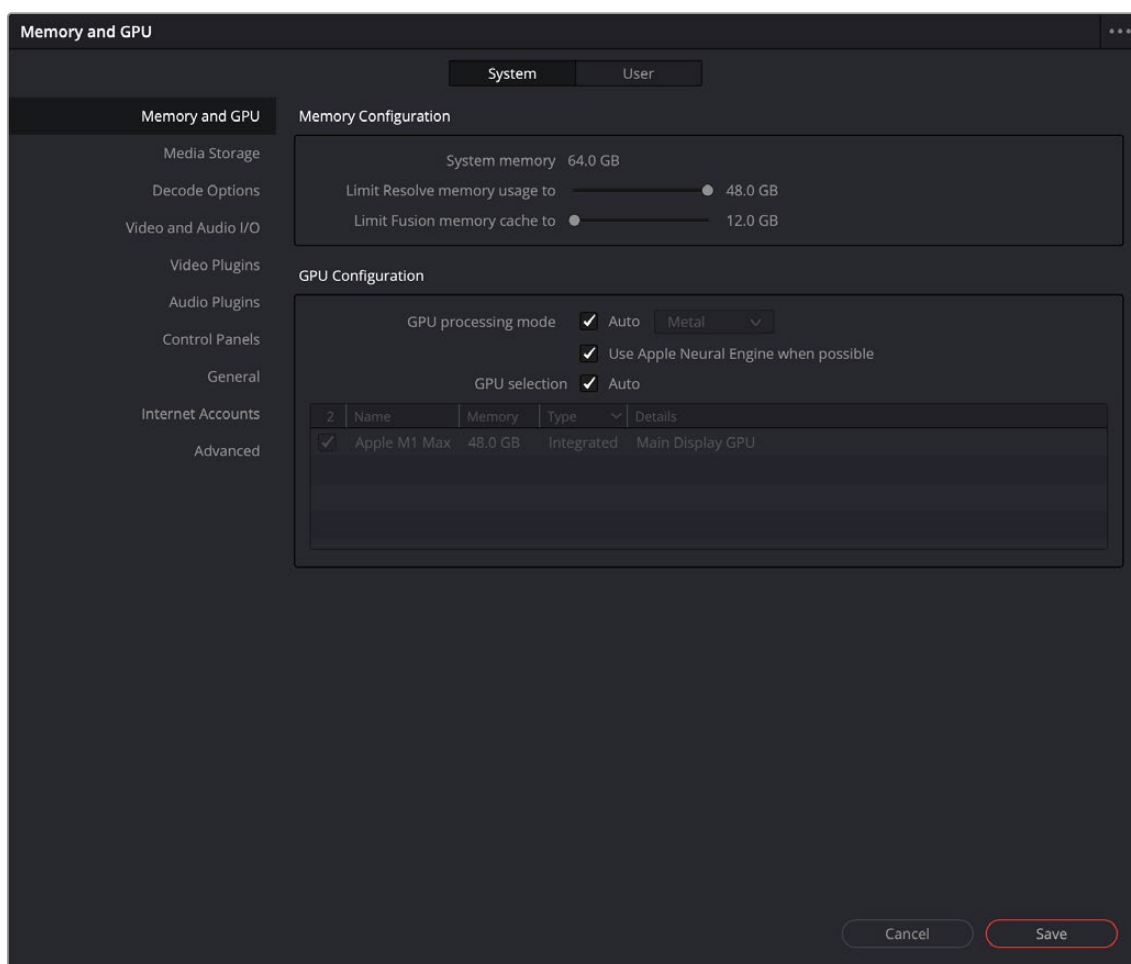
DaVinci Resolve Preferences

The DaVinci Resolve Preferences window contains workstation-specific settings for customizing how DaVinci Resolve works, divided into System and User panes, selectable via buttons at the top of this window.

To open the Project Settings window, do one of the following:

- Choose DaVinci Resolve > Preferences.
- Press Command-Comma.

TIP: You can open the preferences while the Project Manager is open when you first run DaVinci Resolve by pressing Command-Comma.



System Settings of the Preferences window

Adjusting Preferences

The System and User panes are each divided into a series of panels which can be selected from a sidebar at the left. Each panel contains a collection of related settings that affects some category of DaVinci Resolve functionality.

To alter any preference setting:

- 1 Click on the name of any group of settings in the sidebar at the left to open that panel.
- 2 Change whatever settings you need to change.
- 3 Click Save to apply the changes you've made and close the Preferences window.

If you've updated certain System Preferences, you'll be prompted to restart DaVinci Resolve, but if you've updated the User Preferences, this will probably be unnecessary.

Resetting Preferences

Resetting all preferences to their defaults is simple. Click the Option menu at the upper-right corner of the Preferences window and choose Reset System Preferences.

System

The System pane of the Preferences window consists of a series of panels that configure the computer and other hardware that comprises your DaVinci Resolve workstation.

Memory and GPU

The top section of this panel provides Memory Configuration options, while the bottom section of this panel provides controls over how GPU processing is handled.

Memory Configuration

This section has the following preference settings handling memory usage.

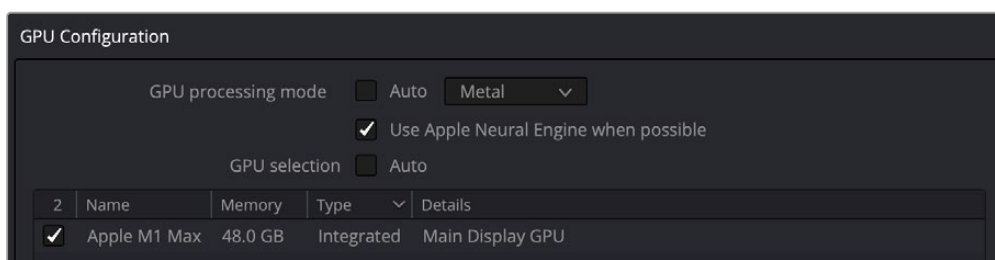
System Memory: The total available RAM on your workstation is listed here.

Limit Resolve Memory Usage to: This preference limits the total amount of system memory that Resolve uses, keeping memory available for other applications. The maximum and default setting for this preference is 75 percent of your system's RAM.

Limit Fusion Memory Cache to: Lets you limit how much RAM the playback cache on the Fusion page is allowed to use. Depending on the length of clips you're working on in the Fusion page, the playback cache can occupy a considerable amount of available memory. The amount you allocate here is taken from the total amount of memory allocated by the "Limit Resolve Memory Usage to" setting.

GPU Configuration

This section lets you choose how GPU processing should be handled.



Options for configuring the GPUs on your workstation

GPU processing mode: Lets you set DaVinci Resolve to use the OpenCL, CUDA, or Metal GPU computing APIs for doing effects processing. Which is best depends on the GPUs that are installed in your computer. Most users can leave this set to Auto to let DaVinci Resolve choose what's appropriate. Otherwise, here are specific recommendations. If you have a macOS system, you should use Metal. Linux and Windows users with AMD GPUs should use OpenCL. Linux and Windows users with Nvidia GPUs should use CUDA, but make sure you have the correct drivers for your system, and that you have the latest update to CUDA installed. Additionally, when you manually choose an option from this drop-down menu, the GPU selection mode drop-down also appears.

Use Apple Neural Engine when possible: Lets you toggle the use of Apple Silicon's Neural Engine in compute tasks.

Use neural engine optimization on NVIDIA: Lets you toggle the use of NVIDIA Neural Engine in compute tasks.

GPU selection mode: Lets you choose between Auto, which lets DaVinci Resolve choose which of the available GPUs on your computer to use for processing, and Manual, which lets you choose which GPUs to enable or disable for processing from a list that appears below. This can be useful in instances where you have multiple GPUs installed on a machine and you want to choose only the most powerful GPUs for processing. This can also be useful in instances where an external eGPU is connected to a laptop or all-in-one with a weaker GPU, so you can choose the more powerful eGPU for processing.

Use Display GPU For Compute: By default, a single GPU system uses the same GPU for the DaVinci user interface and also for image processing. As greater processing speeds are achievable with two or more GPUs, if two GPUs are installed for image processing, this checkbox enables the shared use of the display GPU instead of dedicating it to just the DaVinci user interface. Users of the non-studio version of DaVinci Resolve are restricted to the use of a single GPU.

GPU selection list: This list only appears when GPU processing mode is set to either OpenCL, CUDA, or Metal, and when GPU selection mode is set to Manual. A list of every GPU installed in your computer appears, and you can use checkboxes to the left of each GPU to enable or disable specific GPUs from being used for processing.

Optimized Viewer Updates: This only appears on multi-GPU macOS and Windows systems or on single- and multi-GPU Linux systems; enables faster viewer update performance.

Media Storage

This panel lets you define the scratch disk and other media storage locations used by DaVinci Resolve, as well as proxy locations, and the default cache directories locations to be used when creating new projects.

Media Storage Locations: This list lets you define the scratch disk of the system. The first volume in this list is where Gallery stills and cache files are stored, so you want to make sure that you choose the fastest storage volume to which you have access.

Mapped Mount: This column allows you to specify translatable media path mapping between Mac, Linux, and Windows file system conventions.

Direct I/O: This option allows DaVinci Resolve to write directly to the drive using the kernel buffers, bypassing the normal storage cache in RAM. This allows access to the full performance of the drive.

Automatically display attached storage locations: This checkbox lets DaVinci Resolve access media on all temporarily and permanently mounted volumes, including SATA and eSATA, SAS, USB, FireWire, Thunderbolt, Gigabit Ethernet (GbE or GigE), Fibre Channel, and otherwise connected hard drives, without having to add them to this list. This is on by default.

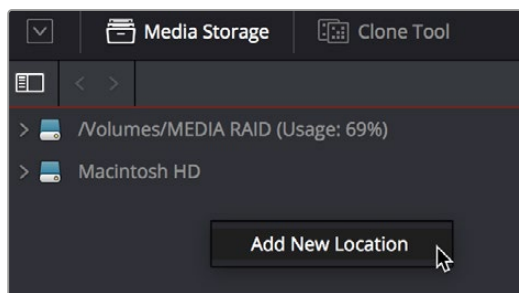
If you're using the Apple App store version of DaVinci Resolve, turning on "Automatically display attached local and network storage locations" automatically prompts you via a dialog to add "Macintosh HD" as a storage location. Clicking Add Location prompts you to select the Macintosh HD volume with another dialog, and clicking Open then adds that volume to the Media Storage Volumes list. After you click Save to close the Preference windows, Resolve should now auto-mount any volumes attached to your computer in the Media Storage browser of the Media page. Don't do this until after you've added a fast storage volume to the Media Storage Locations list, because you don't want Macintosh HD as the first volume in this list – the very first volume in this list should always be reserved for your fast scratch volume.

Proxy Generation Location: These options let you define where any proxy media you create will be rendered to.

- **Proxy subfolders in media file locations:** The proxy media is generated inside a subfolder named "Proxy" at the same level in the file hierarchy as the original media file. This means that if your original media is all in the same folder, you will have one "Proxy" folder containing all of the proxy clips. If your original media is all contained in separate folders (i.e., one folder for each video clip), you will have multiple "Proxy" folders, one inside every clip folder and containing one proxy clip each.
- **Use project settings:** Uses the "Proxy generation location" destination, found in the Working Folders section of the Master Settings of the Project Settings.
- **Ask when creating:** Opens a filesystem dialog, allowing you to select a specific folder for the proxy generation.

Adding Storage Locations Manually

Some versions of DaVinci Resolve do not allow automatic display of attached volumes. In this case, you can right-click anywhere in the background of the Media Storage panel's volumes list on the Media page and choose "Add New Location" to open a dialog you can use to choose a volume you want to add.



Manually adding a volume to the Media Storage panel's volumes list

Using Path Mapping to Access Volumes From Other Operating Systems

Shared media path mapping support for Mac, Linux and Windows makes it easier for multi-system shops to share Resolve projects among different platforms that use different file path conventions.

To add a mapped mount string:

- 1 Open the Media Storage panel of the Resolve Preferences window.
- 2 Add the volume you want to map to the Scratch Disks list.
- 3 Double-click the Mapped Mount column of the drive you added to edit it.
- 4 Enter the alternate file path you want that volume to have. For example, if you're on a Windows workstation and you want to access a Linux volume, type the Linux file path into the Mapped Mount column.

NOTE: If the volume you've selected to use for the cache becomes unavailable, DaVinci Resolve will warn you with a dialog.

Decode Options

This panel contains all options available for using the GPU to accelerate the decoding and debayering of various formats.

Use GPU for Blackmagic RAW decode: Lets you use your GPU to accelerate the decoding of Blackmagic RAW (BRAW) media.

Decode H.264/HEVC using hardware acceleration: Allows the use of hardware acceleration for H.264 or HEVC playback, if available on the computer you're using.

Use easyDCP decoder: Since DaVinci Resolve has its own DCP encoder and decoder built in, this checkbox lets you switch over to using easyDCP to do DCP decoding, if you have a license installed on your workstation.

Automatically refresh growing files in the media pool: If you're using a third-party application that records live to a growing video file, you can now begin to edit that file while it's still recording. Simply import the growing file into the Media Pool, and when this box is checked, DaVinci Resolve will continuously refresh to determine if the file has changed, and automatically update its attributes in the Media Pool.

Stream files during download from Blackmagic Cloud: Check this box to be able to use a clip via streaming, before it downloads completely from the Blackmagic Cloud.

Use GPU for RED Debayer: Lets you use your GPU to accelerate debayering of RED media. The latest RED API enables accelerated 8K debayering using either Metal or Cuda.

There are three options:

- None
- Debayer
- Decompression and Debayer

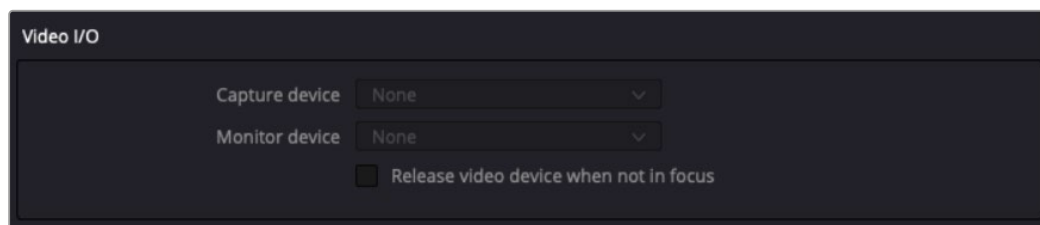
Video & Audio I/O

The preferences in this panel let you choose video and audio interfaces on your workstation.

Video I/O

This section lets you choose which Blackmagic Design video interfaces you want to use for monitoring, capture, playback, and Resolve Live, assuming you have any connected to your workstation. If you have more than one Blackmagic Design video device connected to your computer, you can independently configure them for playback and capture. If no interfaces are connected, no options will be available.

- **Capture Device:** If you have a compatible video capture card for video input, you should choose from the card options that appear here. This setting also sets the selected input device for use in Resolve Live, allowing you to monitor and color correct a live video signal. Any changes to this setting require a restart of the program.
- **Monitor Device:** If you have a compatible video output card, you should choose from the card options that appear here. Leaving this set to “None” disables external video output. Disabling video output can improve real time performance when external monitoring and output is not a priority. You can also choose “None” when you’re using DaVinci Resolve with another application open at the same time that’s using your workstation’s video output interface. When you’ve quit the other application, you can reselect the video output interface for use by DaVinci Resolve. Any changes to this setting require a restart of the program.
- **Release video device when not in focus:** When turned on, DaVinci Resolve releases control of the video output device whenever you switch to another application.
- **Audio monitoring delay:** Allows you to adjust any latency between the video images and the audio monitoring.



Video input/output options in the System Preferences

Audio I/O

This section lets you define the audio hardware and different sets of speakers with which to monitor audio playback. To access more than the default stereo system output that most workstations default to, you must use whatever software is available for your operating system to choose the desired audio hardware you want to use, and define how many audio outputs are required for the type of monitoring you want to do (stereo, immersive, and so on). For example, on macOS you’ll use the Audio MIDI Setup utility to choose output hardware and select a speaker configuration to be made available on your system.

- **I/O Engine:** Lets you choose the audio hardware that DaVinci Resolve uses to process audio. Choices include System Audio, Desktop Video, Fairlight Audio Accelerator, and ASIO (Windows only).
- **System Audio:** System Audio interfaces with your computer’s native audio hardware and enables the following parameters.

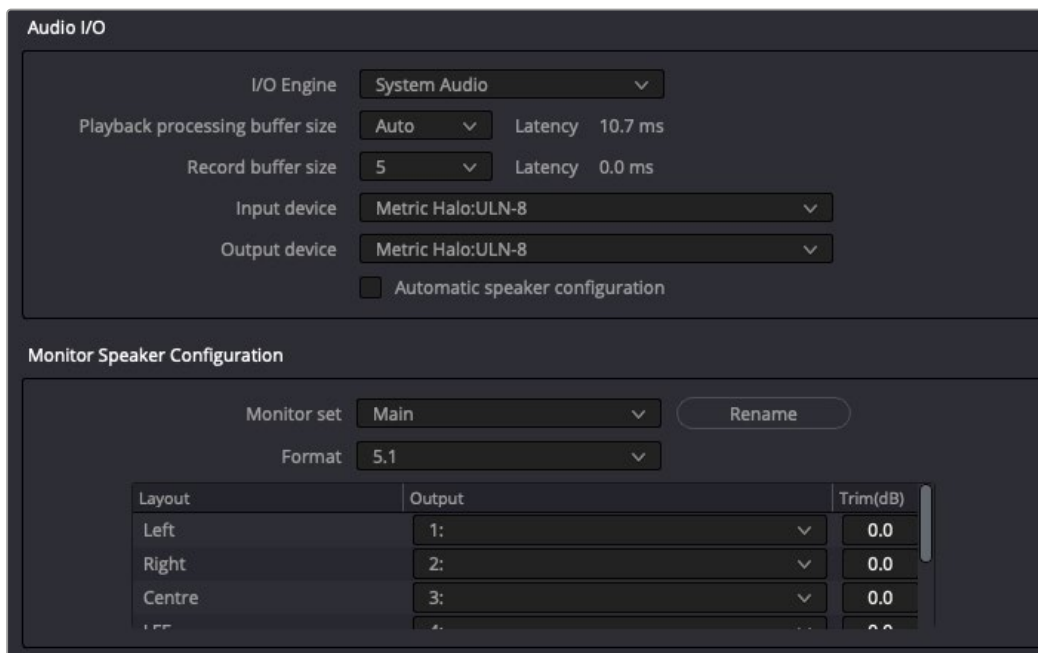
Playback processing buffer size: Lets you determine the size of the Playback buffer; to the right a latency display indicates the approximate latency of your choice in milliseconds.

Record buffer size: Lets you determine the size of the Record buffer; to the right a latency display indicates the approximate latency of your choice in milliseconds.

Input Device: Lets you choose the audio input device from the hardware attached to your system.

Output Device: Lets you choose the audio output device from the hardware attached to your system.

Automatic speaker configuration: Checking this box sets DaVinci Resolve to output audio via your workstation's built-in audio output, even if a compatible video I/O interface is enabled for capture and playback or for Resolve Live. Unchecking this box exposes additional controls with which you can define your own speaker setup.



Assigning different audio I/O devices and required buffer adjustments

About Audio Monitoring and Audio Input

The audio processing throughout DaVinci Resolve, including on the Fairlight page and audio processing using Fairlight FX plugins, is equally compatible with all platforms that DaVinci Resolve runs on, including macOS, Windows, and Linux. In particular, DaVinci Resolve supports audio monitoring and audio input using (i) the audio of a supported Blackmagic Design I/O device such as an UltraStudio or Decklink, (ii) your macOS, Windows, or Linux workstation's on-board audio, (iii) any Core Audio-compatible, Windows-compatible, ASIO, or Advanced Linux Sound Architecture (ALSA)-supported third party audio interface.

Alternately, you can monitor audio with the optional Fairlight Audio Accelerator, which is a PCI card that's designed to handle even more channels of audio I/O monitoring and recording, and that's also capable of accelerating audio processing operations to provide better performance for audio operations.

NOTE: ASIO is a trademark and software of Steinberg Media Technologies GmbH.

Monitor Speaker Configuration

When the Automatic Speaker Configuration box is unchecked it reveals another panel in the Video and Audio I/O Preferences. Here you can assign your monitors to the default Main or Near sets, and you can also create an additional 15 monitor sets specific to your needs.

- **Monitor Set:** Choose the default Main or Near or create up to 15 other user-definable configurations.
- **Rename:** This button allows you to rename any of the monitor sets to something more meaningful for your individual needs.
- **Format:** A drop-down menu allows you to choose the desired format type from Mono up to Dolby Atmos 9.1.6. Below the Format type there are three windows to create the Monitor Set:

Layout: Breaks out the channels that correspond to the chosen format.

Output: Where you can assign the Output channels to your system.

Trim: Where you can reduce each individual level by up to -24dB of gain or add up to +10dB of gain for fine tuning the speaker calibration required for your particular playback space.

Monitor System External Inputs

You can create multiple sets of monitoring with up to 16 user-definable setups from this panel. This allows flexibility to have different combinations of monitoring speakers that you can switch among for checking, reviewing, and creating different mixes.

- **External Monitor Source:** Chose None or up to 16 definable configurations.
- **Rename:** Lets you specify a name for an External Monitor Source.
- **Format:** When a Format is chosen, a drop-down menu appears allowing you to choose the desired format type from Mono up to Dolby Atmos 9.1.6. Once a format has been chosen, three more windows appear:

Layout: Which breaks out the channels that correspond to the chosen format.

Source: Where you can assign either Input Destination or Audio Repro.

Input: Where you can assign an individual track when in Audio Repro, or assign the specific channel when in Input Destination.

- **Rename:** This button allows you to rename any of the numerically labeled monitor sets to something more meaningful for your individual needs.

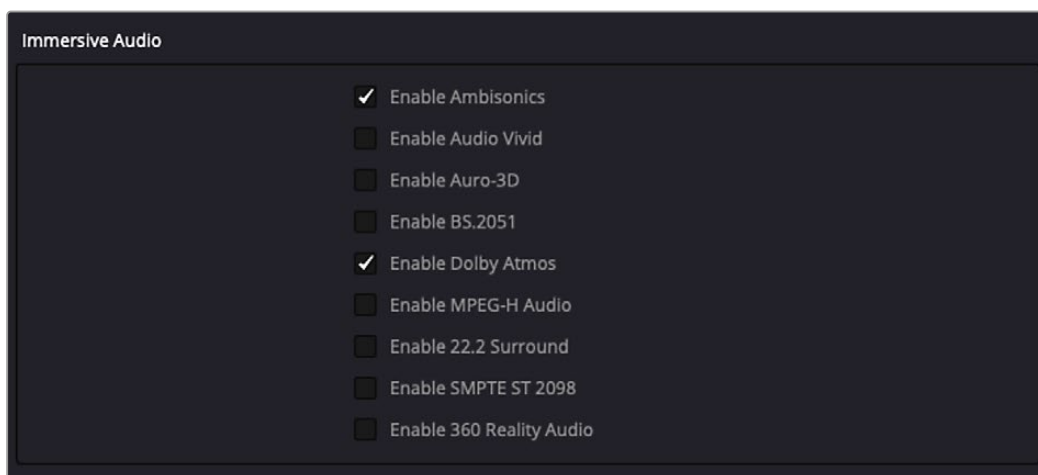
Layout	Source	Input
L	Audio-Repro	Audio 1 L
R	Audio-Repro	Audio 1 L
C	Audio-Repro	Audio 1 L
LFE	Audio-Repro	Audio 1 L
Ls	Audio-Repro	Audio 1 L
Rs	Audio-Repro	Audio 1 L

Patching and renaming different external inputs in Video and Audio I/O Preferences

Immersive Audio Controls

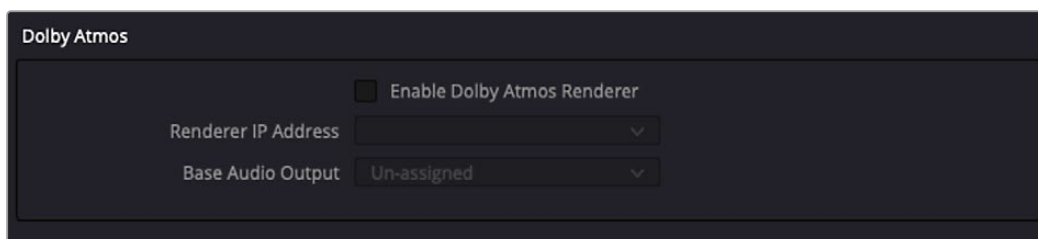
These two Preference panels allow you to configure for the type of immersive audio that you want to have available in your project and also for linking to a Dolby RMU for doing Dolby Atmos mixing.

- **Immersive Audio:** This panel allows you to enable the various types of immersive audio offered within DaVinci Resolve. Those formats are: Ambisonics, Audio Vivid, Auro 3D, BS.2051, Dolby Atmos, MPEG-H Audio, 22.2 Surround, SMPTE ST 2098, and 360 Reality Audio.



Immersive Audio Preferences

- **Dolby Atmos:** Checking this box allows the use of an external Dolby Atmos renderer. Once checked you can enter the IP address of the RMU and choose the base audio output.

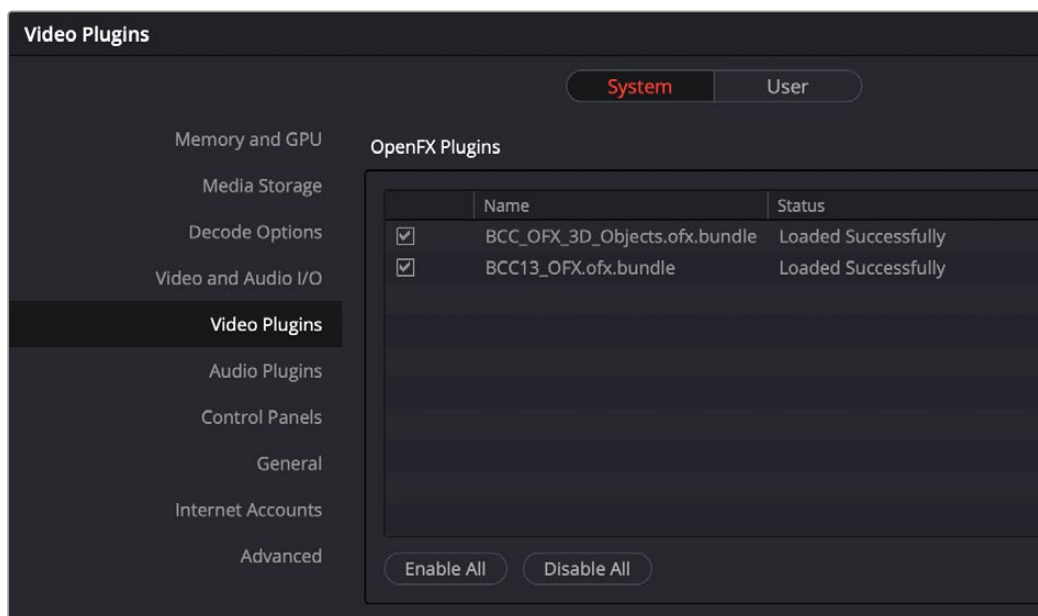


Dolby Atmos Preferences

Video Plugins

You can selectively enable and disable specific Open FX plugins on startup. You can use this function to streamline and organize the Open FX list to just the plugins you commonly use, or to exclude a problematic plugin that causes instability in the system. Additionally, DaVinci Resolve automatically checks the last plugin loading result on startup, and skips any plugins that previously caused a crash or hang.

Individual Open FX plugins can be manually enabled and disabled in the Video Plugins panel by checking or unchecking the boxes corresponding to the plugins.

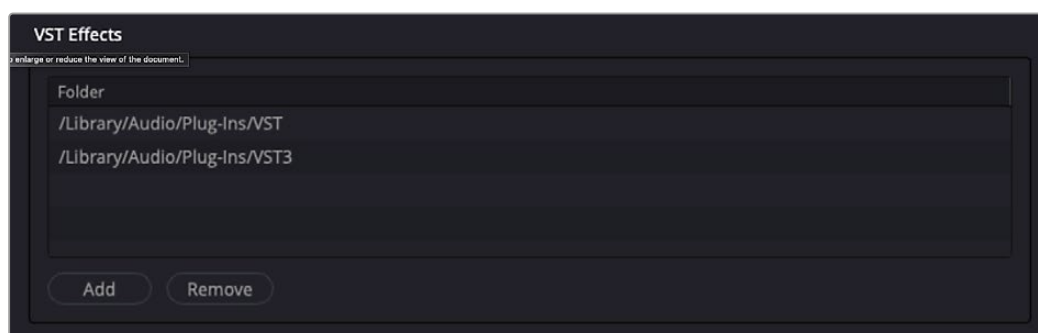


The Video Plugins panel allows you to enable or disable specific Open FX plugins at startup.

Audio Plugins

Three sections of parameters let you manage VST effects, enabled plugins, and external audio processes.

- **VST Effects:** A list at top lets you manually add and remove VST plugin effects directories, if necessary. VST effects aren't installed in a standard location, so it may sometimes be necessary to add a newly installed directory of VST plugins that you've just installed on your system.

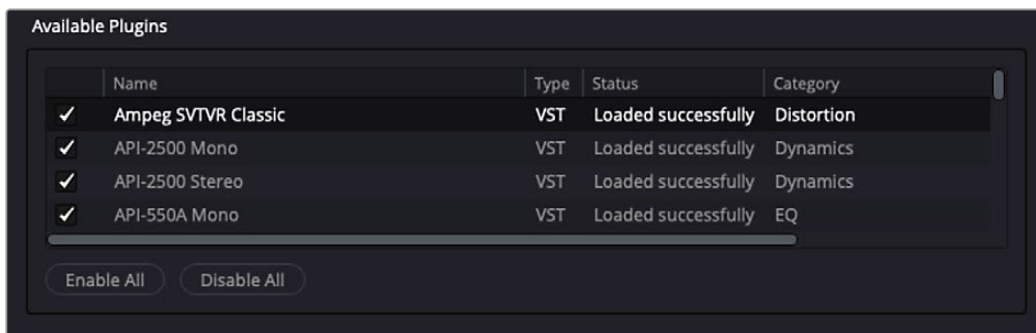


Audio Plugins Preferences - VST Effects

- **Available Plugins:** Once you've added one or more VST directories to the list, a second list underneath shows all audio plugins that are available within these directories. Each plugin on the list has a checkbox that shows whether or not it's currently enabled. Any VST plugins that cause DaVinci Resolve to crash while loading them during startup will be automatically disabled. You can use this list to see which plugins have been disabled, for troubleshooting purposes, and to reenables such "blacklisted" plugins by turning their checkboxes back on.

Category Column: VST and Audio Units plugins are organized into categories within the Fairlight Mixer. You can move a plugin to a different category by clicking its category name and selecting a new one from the Category popup list.

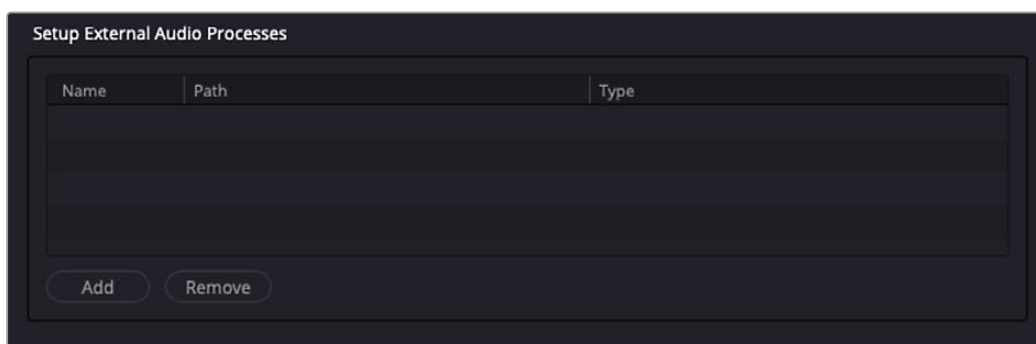
NOTE: This does not apply to Fairlight FX plugins.



Audio Plugins Preferences - Available Plugins

- **Setup External Audio Processes:** While working in the Fairlight page, you have the ability to process an audio file using a third-party application, if necessary, in the event you need to use another application's capabilities to create an effect or solve an issue that can't be accomplished in the Fairlight page itself. To do this, you must first add one or more applications to the External Audio Process list in the Audio Plugins panel of the System Preferences.

NOTE: VST is a trademark of Steinberg Media Technologies GmbH.



Audio Plugins Preferences - Setup External Audio Processes

To add an External Audio Process:

- 1 Click the Add button.
- 2 Double-click the text in the Name column and change the name to that of the application or process you're going to link to.
- 3 Click once in the Path column, and then use the file dialog to locate and select the application or script you want to use as the external audio process.
- 4 Open the drop-down menu in the Type column, and choose how you want the selected audio process to work: Reveal (open the application), Command Line (use from Terminal), or Clipboard (copy the audio clip file path to the clipboard to paste into the open command of an application or utility).
- 5 When you're done, click Save, and restart DaVinci Resolve if you're prompted to.

Control Panels

Two sections let you specify which Color Grading Panel and Audio Console is connected to your workstation.

- **Color Grading Panel:** A menu lets you choose which color grading panel you have connected to your workstation. Some panels expose additional controls.

If you have a DaVinci Resolve Mini or Micro Panel, leave this setting set to None and these panels will be auto-detected by Resolve when you plug them in.

If you have a control panel that connects via USB, choose your panel from the list.

If you have a DaVinci Resolve Mini Panel connected over Ethernet, choose “DaVinci Resolve Mini Panel (Ethernet)” and then choose your panel from the drop-down that appears.

If you’re using a JLCopier Eclipse, choose “JLCopier Eclipse CX” and then enter the IP and Port number into the fields that appear.

- **Audio Console:** A menu lets you choose which Fairlight Audio Console you have connected to your workstation. Some panels expose additional controls.
- **Use MIDI Audio Console:** A checkbox lets you enable the use of a third-party audio console that’s connected to your workstation. Turning this on exposes three additional menus.

MIDI Protocol: Lets you choose either the HUI or MCU protocol, whichever is compatible with the audio console you want to use.

MIDI Input: Lets you choose the MIDI input used to connect your console.

MIDI Output: Lets you choose the MIDI output used to connect your console.

- **Head Tracker:** A menu lets you choose which head tracker profile to use for immersive audio.

General

This panel provides various options for scripting, audio processing, monitoring, and sending problem reports.

- **External Scripting Using:** (Resolve Studio only) Options include None, Local, and Network. When set to None, only scripting in the Console window is allowed. When set to Local, external scripts and applications on the same computer can control DaVinci Resolve. When set to Network, external scripts and applications from other computers on the network (or via the internet) can control DaVinci Resolve.
- **Use 10-bit precision in viewers if available:** This checkbox only appears on macOS installations of DaVinci Resolve. Turning this checkbox on lets DaVinci Resolve display 10-bit images in the Viewer.
- **Use Mac Display Color Profile for viewers:** If you’re using DaVinci Resolve on macOS, this checkbox enables all viewers in DaVinci Resolve to use whatever display profile is selected in the Displays panel of the System Preferences. This lets DaVinci Resolve use ColorSync on macOS so your Viewer image should better match your output display.
- **Optimize project library cloud data traffic:** If you’re having difficulty accessing the Blackmagic Cloud through a corporate firewall, check this box to connect without having to set port mapping and firewall exceptions. <https://blackmagicdesign.com> still needs to be whitelisted for access.
- **Automatically Tag Rec.709 Scene Clips as Rec.709-A:** Turn this checkbox on to automatically tag any Rec. 709 QuickTime files for Rec. 709-A playback. This setting is useful if your final QuickTime video does not match what you see in the Resolve viewers (gamma shift), and you wish to export for the web rather than broadcast.

- **Automatically Scan other project libraries for remote rendering jobs:** Turn this checkbox on to scan all connected project libraries, rather than just the current project library for possible remote rendering jobs.
- **Automatically Check for Updates:** Turn this checkbox on to make it easier to ensure you're using the latest version of DaVinci Resolve. You can also choose DaVinci Resolve > Check For Updates to notify you of new versions and download them when available.
- **Automatically opt-in for new beta program notifications:** Lets you know when public beta versions of DaVinci Resolve become available, in case you're interested in living on the edge.
- **Send report when application quits unexpectedly:** When this checkbox is turned on, this setting enables DaVinci Resolve to automatically prepare a problem report whenever DaVinci Resolve unexpectedly quits. You get to fill out some information (please be as specific as you can about what you were doing when DaVinci Resolve had its issue) and click a button to send the report.
- **Limit Presentations upload speed to X KB/s:** Allows you to set a hard limit on the upload speed while using Presentations to avoid saturating all your network bandwidth.
- **Use Remote Monitoring without Blackmagic Cloud:** Allows you to use remote monitoring on your own network instead of going through Blackmagic Cloud.
- **Use TURN server for Remote Monitoring:** If you are not using Blackmagic Cloud for security reasons and you are using a self-configured or cloud-based TURN servers to route and relay monitoring streams, enter that server here.
- **Prevent sleeping when Blackmagic Cloud sync enabled project is open:** This checkbox is on by default and prevents your computer from entering sleep mode while a Blackmagic Cloud project is active to make sure all online data transfers complete. Uncheck this box to let your computer go to sleep whenever it wants.
- **Automatically send problem reports:** When this checkbox is turned on, problem reports are automatically sent, with no user intervention. You have the option of adding your name and email address to be automatically included, but this information is optional.

Internet Accounts

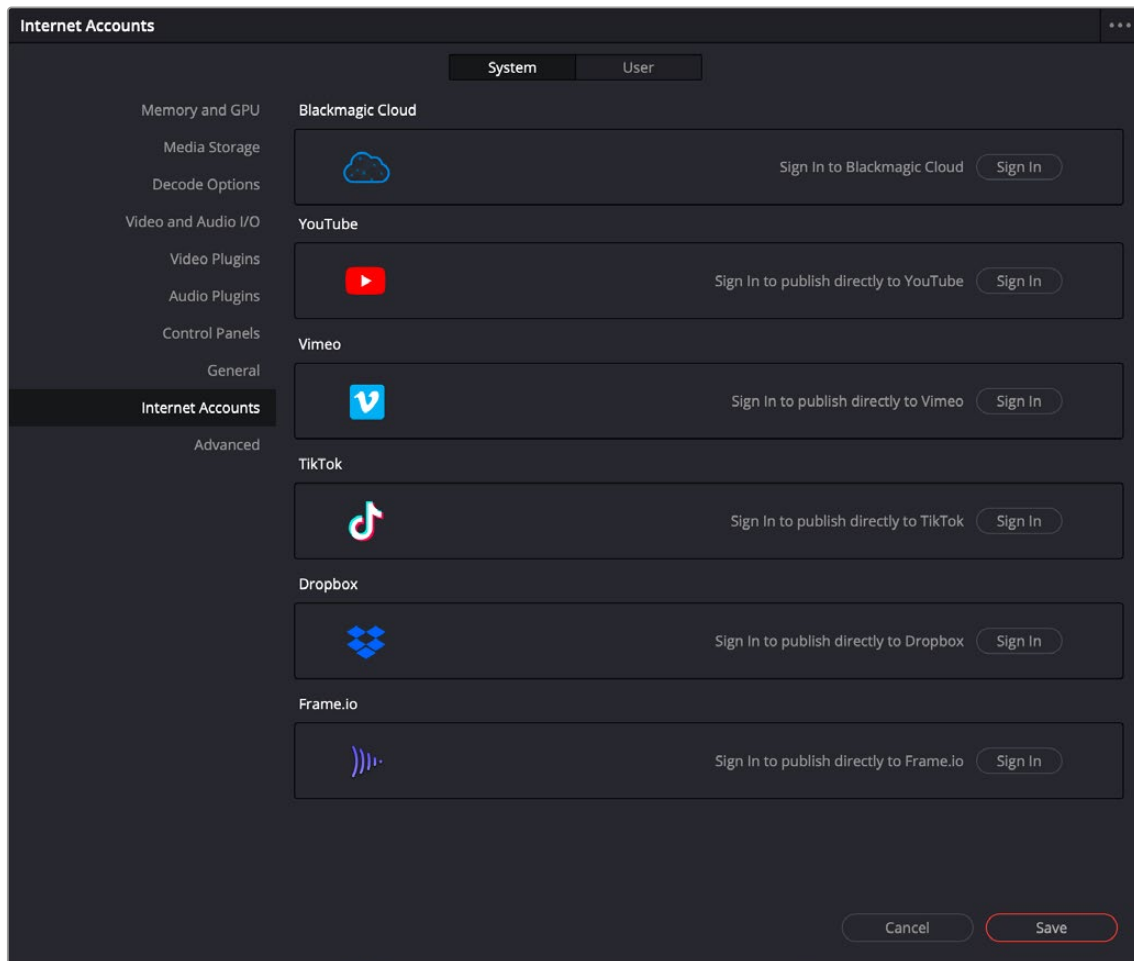
The Internet Accounts panel serves as a login manager for the Blackmagic Cloud and other social media sites.

DaVinci Resolve has tight integration with YouTube, Vimeo, TikTok, Dropbox, and Frame.io that allows you to render and upload directly to each service. This panel provides buttons that let you sign into your YouTube, Vimeo, TikTok, Dropbox, and Frame.io accounts, as well as specify a local cache location for media being synced with Frame.io.

For each service you sign into, a floating window presents the interface in which you'll need to enter your login name and password to enable integration, followed by whatever two-factor identification and other required steps are necessary. Once entered, DaVinci Resolve will sign in to each of these services automatically when DaVinci Resolve opens.

Advanced

This tab is used for special Resolve configurations and SAN parameters that are applicable to older file systems.



The Internet Accounts panel of the System tab of the DaVinci Resolve Preferences window

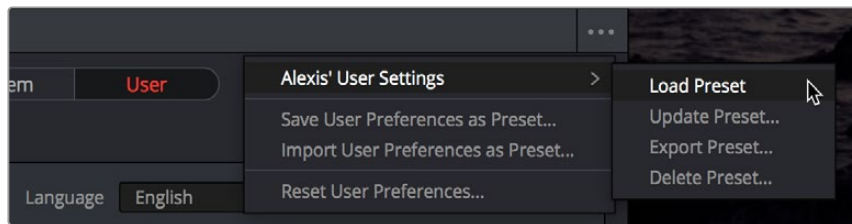
User

This panel lets you choose user preferences, specific to your workstation, that govern such things as UI behaviors and appearance, auto save settings, editing and color defaults, control panel action, and keyboard shortcut mappings.

TIP: Many of the settings in the User panel used to be found in the Project Settings window prior to version 14, but they were moved here to accommodate collaborative workflows with each user having their own independent general, editing, and color settings, as well as their own keyboard shortcuts.

Saving User Preference Presets

It's possible to save multiple presets for instant recall of different User Preference settings, using the Option menu in the UI Settings window.



The commands for managing User Preference presets in the Option menu of the UI Settings window

Methods of managing User Preference presets:

- **To save a preset:** Choose whatever settings you want to use, then click the UI Settings window Option menu, and choose Save User Preferences as Preset. Enter a name into the dialog, and click OK. That preset will now appear at the top of the Option menu.
- **To load a preset:** Click the UI Settings window Option menu, and choose Load Preset from the submenu of the preset you want to load.
- **To update a preset:** Load a preset you want to edit, then change whatever settings you need to, and choose Update Preset from the submenu of that preset in the Option menu.
- **To export a preset:** Choose Export Preset from the submenu of any preset in the Option menu. A file with the .userprefs extension is saved at the location you chose.
- **To import a preset:** Choose Import User Preferences as Preset in the Option menu, use the dialog to find the exported .userprefs preset file you want to import, and click Open.
- **To delete a preset:** Choose Delete Preset from the submenu of any preset in the Option menu.
- **To reset all presets:** Choose Reset User Preferences from the Option menu to restore all User Preferences to their default settings.

UI Settings

A collection of operational preferences.

- **Language:** A Language drop-down at the top lets you specify which language the DaVinci Resolve user interface displays. DaVinci Resolve currently supports English, Chinese, Japanese, Spanish, Portuguese, French, German, Italian, Russian, Thai, Vietnamese, and Korean.
- **Reload last working project on startup:** Automatically reopens the last project a user had open whenever that user logs back into DaVinci Resolve. This checkbox can only be enabled when editing a preset configuration in the Presets panel, so that it's always on no matter which project you open as long as you're using that particular preset.
- **Show focus indicators in the User Interface:** Lets you enable or disable a red line at the top of each panel that indicates which panel currently has focus.
- **Use gray background for user interface:** By default, DaVinci Resolve uses a blue-gray UI background, intended to provide a more attractive experience for users focused on the less color-critical aspects of DaVinci Resolve, namely editing. Turning this checkbox on switches DaVinci Resolve to a totally neutral, desaturated gray UI, which can be valuable as a point of reference for colorists concerned about the blue-gray UI's potential to bias the eye in the dark environment of the grading suite.
- **Use gray background in viewers:** When turned on, sets the background of all viewers to gray, making it easier to evaluate image blanking or minor sizing adjustments than with the default dark background.
- **Resize image in viewer to square pixels:** This control will select between using a square or non-square pixel aspect ratio within the Viewer. This is important when working with SD images which do not have a square pixel aspect ratio.

- **Delay viewer display by X frames:** When turned on, you can enter a number of frames to delay DaVinci Resolve Viewers as they appear on your computer displays so that the image on your computer display better syncs up with the same image shown on external displays that are delayed due to various signal processing processes.
- **Output single field when paused:** This setting will reduce flicker when grading using a computer monitor or when working with interlaced material. Ordinarily, when viewing interlaced material in Stop or Pause mode, field one is displayed followed by field two. Depending on the image, this can result in a flicker on the display. When this option is enabled, only field one will be shown on the monitor when playback is paused; however both fields will be shown when the clips are played.
- **Stop playback when a dropped frame is detected:** When enabled, sets DaVinci Resolve to stop playback whenever a frame is dropped on output, to warn you that there are performance issues on your workstation. This is particularly useful when you're outputting to tape.
- **Stop renders when a frame or clip cannot be processed:** When enabled, this will halt a render if DaVinci Resolve detects an error in the encoding, rather than continue to try to process it.
- **Show playhead shadow:** Checking this box turns on the playhead shadow, a transparent orange range used for visually measuring that extends a certain number of frames before and after the playhead. The number of frames in the range before or after the playhead can be adjusted in the Editing section of the User Preferences.
- **2D timeline scrolling:** Checking this box will scroll the Timeline vertically through all the Video or Audio tracks when moving the mouse wheel. Unchecking this box will scroll the entire Timeline horizontally when moving the mouse wheel.
- **Timeline sort order:** A user setting that allows you to determine the default sort order of the Timelines that appear in the Viewer drop-down menus throughout DaVinci Resolve.

Alphabetic: Sorts Timelines alphabetically A-Z.

Creation Date: Sorts Timelines by oldest creation date first.

Recently Used (default): Sorts Timelines by the last 10 actively used timelines.

Project Save and Load

The Project Save and Load panel lets you control how projects are opened, and how they're saved.

Load Settings

The Load Settings preference lets you control a key aspect of project opening performance, namely whether or not all timelines within a given project are loaded into memory at the time of opening.

- **Load all timelines when opening projects:** To improve the performance of longer projects with multiple timelines, the "Load all timelines when opening projects" checkbox in the Project Save and Load panel of the User Preferences defaults to off.

When this checkbox is off, opening a project only results in the last timeline you worked on being opened into memory; all other timelines are not loaded into RAM. This speeds up the opening of large projects. However, you may experience brief pauses when you open other timelines within that project, as each new timeline must be loaded into RAM as you open it. If you open a particularly gigantic timeline, a progress bar will appear letting you know how long it will take to load. Another advantage of this is the reduction of each project's memory footprint, which is particularly valuable when working among multiple projects using Dynamic Project Switching.

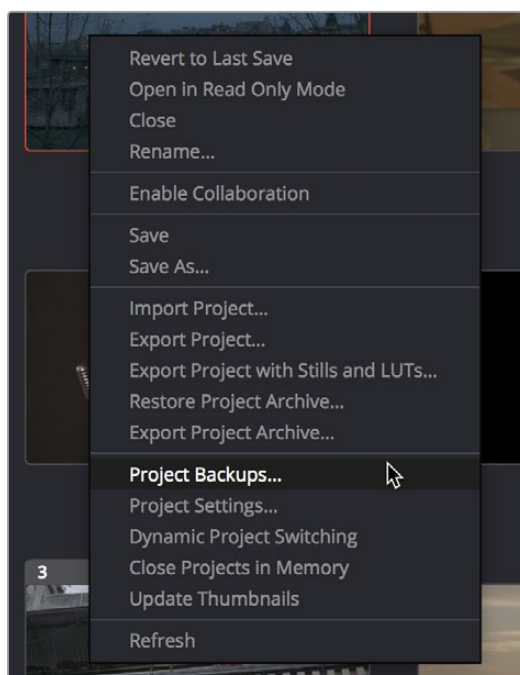
If you turn this on, all timelines will be loaded into RAM, and you'll experience no pauses when opening timelines you haven't opened already. However, projects with many timelines may take longer to open and save.

Save Settings

The Save settings allow you to control how DaVinci Resolve handles automated saving and project backups. These features can save you from the heartache of lost work resulting from an unexpected problem.

- **Live Save:** Enabled by default, Live Save is a progressive, fast, always-on autosave mechanism that “saves as you go.” All changes in the Cut, Edit, and Fairlight pages are saved as you make them. All changes in the Fusion and Color pages are automatically saved when you switch to another clip, and also periodically and invisibly in the background while you work to ensure that your work is saved even if you haven’t switched clips in a while.
- **Project Backups:** Turning on the Project Backups checkbox in the Project Save and Load panel of the User Preferences enables DaVinci Resolve to save multiple backup project files at periodic intervals, using a method that’s analogous to a GFS (grandfather father son) backup scheme. This can be done regardless of whether or not Live Save is turned on. Each project backup is a complete project file, excluding stills and LUTs.

Once you’ve enabled Project Backups for a long enough time, whatever saved project backups have been created are retrievable in the Project Manager via the contextual menu that appears when you right-click a project, by choosing Project Backups. Opening a project backup does not overwrite the original project; project backups are always opened as independent projects.

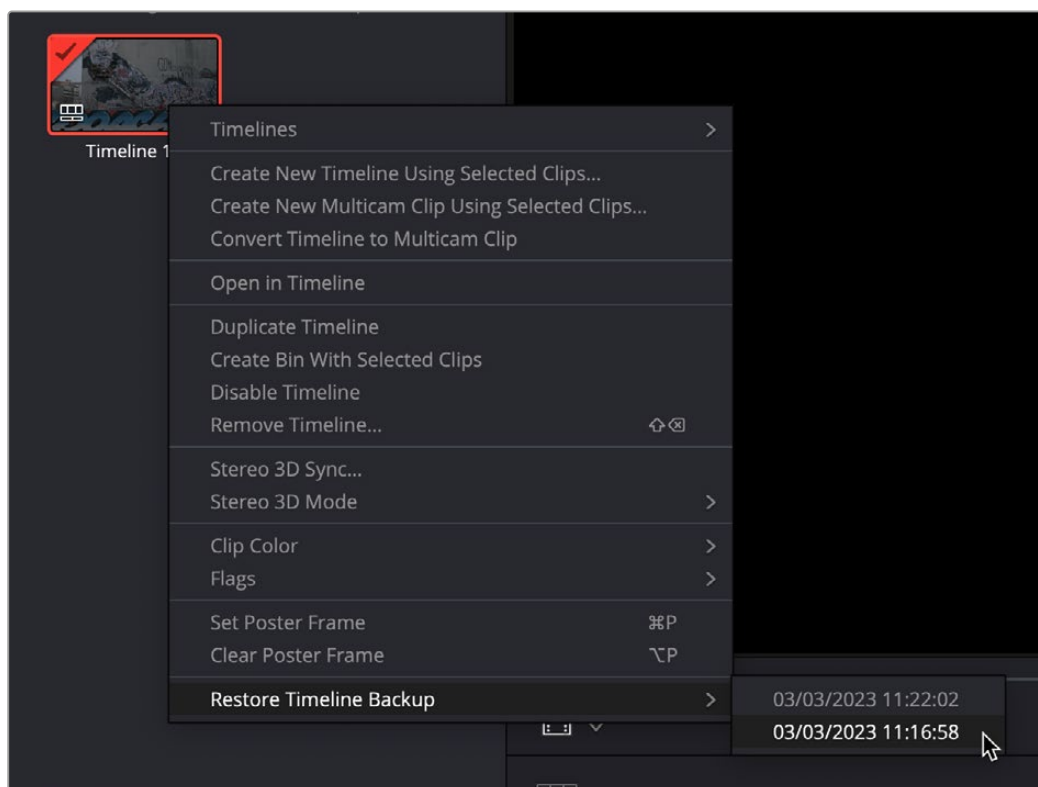


Restoring a project backup in the Project Browser

- **Timeline Backups:** Turning on the Timeline Backups checkbox in the Project Save and Load panel of the User Preferences enables DaVinci Resolve to save multiple backups of a timeline at periodic intervals, using a method that’s analogous to a GFS (grandfather-father-son) backup scheme. This can be done regardless of whether or not Live Save is turned on.

If you want to revert to a previous backup of a timeline, simply right-click on the timeline in the Media Pool, select Restore Timeline Backup from the contextual menu, and choose the backup from the list of options. Backups are organized by date and time, making it easy to find the specific timeline you want to restore.

Restoring a timeline backup does not overwrite your current timeline. Instead the selected backup will be brought into the Media Pool as a new timeline, with the name “Backup” appended to it.



Restoring a timeline backup in the Media Pool

Project and Timeline backups are only saved when changes have been made to a project. If DaVinci Resolve sits idle for any period of time, such as when your smart watch tells you to go outside and walk around the block, no additional project backups are saved, preventing DaVinci Resolve from overwriting useful backups with unnecessary ones.

Three fields let you specify how often to save a new backup, while the fourth lets you choose where the backups will be saved. These settings apply to both Project and Timeline backups.

Perform backups every X minutes: The first field specifies how often to save a new backup within the last hour you've worked. By default, a new backup is saved every 10 minutes, resulting in six backups within the last hour. Once an hour of working has passed, an hourly backup is saved and the per-minute backups begin to be discarded on a first in, first out basis. By default, this means that you'll only ever have six backups at a time that represent the last hour's worth of work.

Hourly backups for the past X hours: The second field specifies how many hourly project backups you want to save. By default, two hourly backups will be saved for the current day. Past that number, hourly backups will begin to be discarded on a first in, first out basis.

Daily backups for the past X days: The third field specifies for how many days you want to save backups. The very last backup saved on any given day is preserved as the daily backup for that day, and by default daily backups are only saved for two days. Past that number, daily backups will begin to be discarded on a first in, first out basis. If you're working on a project over a longer stretch of time, you can always raise this number.

Backup location: Click the Browse button to choose a location for these backups to be saved. By default they're saved to a "ProjectBackup" directory on your scratch disk, although you could change this to a volume that better fits into your data backup methodology. This folder contains both Project and Timeline backups.

Cache Management

This section allows you to delete your local cache automatically after a certain number of days to keep your drive from filling up with older projects.

Of course, you can always manage these files manually from the Playback > Manage Render Cache menu, but this new preference lets you set and forget a cleanup operation.

Media Cache Settings

Delete Cache files older than xx days: Check the box and select the number of days after which the automatic deletion of the Cache files will occur.

Editing

The settings in this panel affect new timeline settings, editorial default values, trim behaviors, timeline UI appearance, and frame interpolation settings.

New Timeline Settings

These settings define the presets that populate the New Timeline Options window whenever you create a new timeline.

- **Start Timecode:** You can change the Start Timecode if a specific start time is required.
- **No. of Video Tracks:** Enter how many video tracks you want to have. You can also drag within this field to adjust the number of video tracks with a virtual slider.
- **No. of Audio Tracks:** Enter how many audio tracks you want to have. You can also drag within this field to adjust the number of audio tracks with a virtual slider.
- **Audio Track Type:** Choose the channel mapping you want the new audio tracks to use.

Automatic Smart Bins

These settings let DaVinci Resolve automatically create Smart Bins whenever clips with relevant metadata appear in the Media Pool, or whenever such metadata is added to clips that are already in the Media Pool. You can choose which Smart Bins are automatically created via a series of checkboxes.

General Settings

These settings define the timing of resolve-generated effects and editing operations.

- **Standard generator duration:** Defines the default duration of generators you edit into the Timeline, in Seconds or Frames. The default value is 5 seconds.
- **Standard transition duration:** Defines the duration of transitions, in Seconds or Frames, that you add to an edit point in DaVinci Resolve. The default value is 1 second.
- **Standard still duration:** Defines the duration of stills that you import such as TIFF, PNG and other supported graphic file formats, in Seconds or Frames. The default value is 5 seconds.
- **Pre-roll time:** Determines how much of the Timeline before the current position of the playhead to play when using the Play Around command.
- **Post-roll time:** Determines how much of the Timeline after the current position of the playhead to play when using the Play Around command.

- **Audio subframe nudge:** Determines the number of milliseconds or subframes are nudged when you use the Subframe Left/Right controls.
- **Default handles length:** The value used when creating a timeline with handles. The default is one second worth of frames.
- **Default fast nudge length:** The number of frames that are nudged when you use the Shift-Comma (,) and Shift-Period (.) keyboard shortcuts.
- **Pre-playhead shadow length:** The number of frames in the Timeline prior to the playhead covered by the Playhead Shadow, if enabled by checking the “Show playhead shadow box” in the User UI Settings preferences.
- **Post-playhead shadow length:** The number of frames in the Timeline after the playhead covered by the Playhead Shadow, if enabled by checking the “Show playhead shadow box” in the User UI Settings preferences.
- **Timeline overlay retains the last performed action:** Turn this checkbox on if you want DaVinci Resolve to always remember the last edit type you used in the Timeline Viewer Overlay, and highlight it on this Overlay whenever you drag another clip over the Timeline Viewer to let you know that the last edit you performed is the new default edit if you drop clips to the left of the overlay.
- **Always highlight current clip in the media pool:** When turned on, any clips at the position of the playhead on the Edit or Color pages will be automatically highlighted in the Media Pool.
- **Prioritize pasting to the in and out range:** Normally, pasted clips appear at the playhead position in the timeline. Check this box if you wish them to be pasted according to the timeline in and out points instead.
- **Sync the Master Timeline to the current frame:** If you turned on “Automatically match master timeline with media pool” in the Color settings, then this option lets you make sure that whenever you open the Master Timeline, the playhead is at the same clip and frame that it was in the previous Timeline you were working on.
- **Show offline reference for timeline gaps:** If there’s a missing clip in a conformed timeline that results in a gap in the Timeline Editor, turning this option on sets DaVinci Resolve to show the corresponding frames of an “offline reference movie,” if one has been assigned to that timeline, instead of black. This can be helpful in emergency situations when you’re missing timeline clips right before a screening or review session; this feature lets you play or output the missing frames using the corresponding media from the offline reference movie, instead of outputting black.

For more information on using and assigning Offline Reference Movies, see *Chapter 55, “Preparing Timelines for Import and Comparison.”*

- **Show offline reference for non-conformed edits:** If there’s missing media in a project that results in an unlinked clip in the Timeline Editor (represented by a red exclamation point overlay on that clip), turning this option on sets DaVinci Resolve to show the corresponding frames of an “offline reference movie,” if one has been assigned to that timeline, instead of black. This can be helpful in emergency situations when you’re missing source media right before a screening or review session; this feature lets you play or output the missing frames using the corresponding media from the offline reference movie, instead of outputting black.

For more information on using and assigning Offline Reference Movies, see *Chapter 55, “Preparing Timelines for Import and Comparison.”*

- **Use custom safe area overlays:** When turned on, displays Action Area and Title Area fields that let you set a custom percentage for each. The default values are 93% for Action Area and 90% for Title Area.
- **Align audio edits to frame boundaries:** When turned on, the In and Out points of audio clips always align themselves with whole frame boundaries, just like video clips. When turned off, you can perform subframe audio edits to audio-only clips, or to linked audio when you've suspended linked selection.
- **Configure clips as multi-mono on import:** Checking this box allows you to import any multichannel audio in a multiple mono configuration. This lets you take any Stereo, 5.1, or other multichannel sources and automatically configures them to multiple mono files with the same number of tracks when you add them to the Media Pool.
- **Limit media pool audio sync to first timecode match:** When two or more audio clips overlap timecode with a video clip, the default behavior is to sync all overlapping audio clips by making as many new tracks as necessary. Checking this box replaces this behavior by having DaVinci Resolve choose what it thinks is the most likely single audio track, and sync just that single audio clip, ignoring the others.
- **Import Finder tags as Keywords (Mac only):** When turned on, any color tags that are set and defined in Mac OS for a media file will automatically be imported as keyword metadata alongside that media file.

NOTE: Even when Align audio edits to frame boundaries is turned off, if linked selection is on, you'll be unable to make subframe edits while you're resizing both the audio and video of linked clips.

Text

Check the Display Only Specific Fonts box to explicitly limit the font options shown for your text elements. This lets you set a white list of fonts that you are cleared to use, and hide all other fonts on the system.

To set up an allowed fonts list:

- 1 Check the box in Preferences > User > Editing > Text > Display Only Specific Fonts.
- 2 Select a font filter file.

A font filter file is any UTF-8 text file with a combination of explicit font names or text with asterisk wildcards to match multiple fonts, listed one entry per line.

`*Gothic*` (any font name with Gothic in it)

`Arial`

`Helvetica*` (any font name beginning with Helvetica)

`Open Sans`

Default Fades

These settings define the curves of the default audio fades in Fairlight.

- **Fade In/Out:** Define the curve type for fade ins and outs.
- **Crossfades:** Define the curve type for the ins and out of the crossfade.

Checkboxes for None, Equal Power, and Equal Gain for crossfade type.

Color

The settings in this panel govern different behaviors in the Color page.

General Settings

Affect a variety of behaviors while working in the Color page.

- **Master reset maintains RGB balance:** Defines how the DaVinci control panel trackball/ring reset buttons reset primary color adjustments. When this option is turned off (the default), pressing the ALL Reset button returns the primary correction values to their default values. When this checkbox is turned on, then pressing the ALL Reset button (a) resets the YRGB values so that the overall values are kept and the ratio of YRGB to each other is maintained, and (b) pressing the RGB Reset button sets the three color channels to the average of what they were previously set to.
- **Wipe wraps when viewing reference stills:** Turning this on (the default) lets stills wrap around the edge of the screen while you're adjusting the wipe using the mouse, rather than stopping at the screen's edge. If you find this behavior awkward when trying to quickly create full-frame comparisons with stills to flip on and off, it can be disabled.
- **High-Visibility Power Window Outlines:** Turning this on sets Power Window outlines to be drawn as green (for the center shape) and yellow (for the softness shapes), to make these windows easier to see in certain circumstances, instead of the default white and gray.
- **Mattes display high contrast black and white:** When enabled, the HILITE command, which displays the current key, shows a black and white matte (i.e., high contrast) rather than the standard gray matte.

For more information on this setting, and on use of the HILITE command, see *Chapter 135*, "Secondary Qualifiers."

- **Next scene switches to visible track:** When grading a project with multiple tracks, you can use this option to alter the "next scene" command to work better in projects with multi-clip composites. With this option turned off, pressing NEXT SCENE on the DaVinci control panel, or using the Down Arrow keyboard shortcut, moves the playhead to the very next clip in the Thumbnail timeline, regardless of whether it's in front of or behind another clip. Turning this option on causes the NEXT SCENE command to move the playhead to the clip in the highest track if the next clip is part of a multi-clip composite with multiple clips stacked over one another.
- **Previous or Next node navigates only to correctors:** Node navigation only selects corrector nodes and bypasses mixer, splitter and combiner nodes, etc.
- **Preserve node numbers when adding nodes:** Checking this box increments the node numbering by the order in which they are created, regardless of its position in the node tree. Unchecked reflows the node numbering automatically based on the node's position in the tree.
- **Always perform copy and paste on selected nodes:** Bypasses the interface focus-based selection for copying and pasting full grades vs. individual nodes. When checked, DaVinci Resolve will only copy and paste between selected nodes regardless of the interface focus.
- **Use Legacy Auto Color:** As of DaVinci Resolve 16, the A button in the Color Wheels palette and the Shot Match command available from the Thumbnail Timeline contextual menu both now use advanced algorithms, based on the DaVinci Neural Engine, to provide superior results when automatically adjusting color balance and contrast. This checkbox lets you set the A button to use the older algorithm instead.
- **Use Legacy Shot Match:** As of DaVinci Resolve 16, the Shot Match command available from the Thumbnail Timeline contextual menu uses an advanced algorithm, based on the DaVinci Neural Engine, to provide superior results when automatically adjusting color balance and contrast. This checkbox lets you set the Shot Match command to use the older algorithm instead.

- **Histogram Background on Grading Tools:** This drop-down menu lets you turn the histogram that appears in the background of the Curves palette either Off, On based on the node's Input (changes made to the curve do not affect the background histogram), or On based on the node's Output (changes made to the curve do affect the background histogram).
- **Automatically cue x frames into timeline clips:** This setting affects the operation of the NEXT SCENE and PREV SCENE commands in the Color page. The default cue point when moving from one clip to the next is the first frame of each clip. Entering a value, in frames, in this field sets the default cue point to the specified number of frames after the first frame of each clip you move the playhead to. This can be convenient if the source material has black or camera rollup flashes at the beginning of every clip while you're trying to grade dailies.
- **Neighboring Clips in Split Screen:** Lets you choose how many neighboring clips next to the current clips are shown in a grid in the Color page Viewer when you turn on the Neighbor Clips option of the Split-Screen shot comparison control.
- **Switching clips:** (this setting can also be changed from the Option menu in the Node Editor) When switching clips, DaVinci Resolve can switch to the same or another node in the node graph. The four options below determine which node is selected:
 - Selects last adjusted node:** The default setting, where each clip in the Timeline retains its own independent node selection that's remembered whenever you move back to that clip.
 - Selects first node:** The first node is always selected when you move to another clip.
 - Selects last node:** The last node is always selected when you move to another clip.
 - Selects same node:** If the clip you've moved to has as many or more nodes as the last clip, the node of the same number will be selected. If the clip you've moved to has fewer nodes than the last clip, the next highest node will be selected.
- **Color picker:** Changes the way that colors are selected when using the Secondary color correction controls. DaVinci Resolve is the normal and modern mode, however some colorists who are familiar with the legacy 2K prefer the DaVinci 2K mode.

Ripple Mode

This setting determines the behavior of the Ripple command that's initiated in the Color page.

- **Target clips are set to:** The Ripple mode that's used when you select a Ripple command in the Color page, either using the RIPPLE button on the Advanced Panel, or selected from the Color menu.

For more information on using this function, see *Chapter 142, "Grade Management."*

Exact values changed: Changes made to the current clip are rippled to the specified clips using the exact parameters that were changed. For example, if the Master Gain level in the current clip is changed to 0.75 of its range, each clip you ripple will have a Master Gain level of 0.75. Only parameters you adjust are rippled.

Percent value changed: Changes made to the current clip are rippled to the specified clips by the percentage of change you made to the altered parameters. For example, if the current clip has a Master Gain level of 1.00 and is changed to 0.90 units, then the Master Gain level of each clip you ripple will have a relative reduction of 10% relative to its previous value.

Unit values changed: Changes made to the current clip are rippled to the specified clips by the same delta of change, using whichever units make sense for the affected parameter. For example, if the current clip had a Master Gain of 0.80 and you increased it to 0.90, each rippled scene's Master Gain level increases by 0.10.

All values are copied: The current clip's grade is rippled to the specified clips in its entirety. No comparison is made with the original clip's parameters, and all memory parameters are rippled.

Printer Light Step Calibration

For film projects, when you have tight integration with a film lab, it is possible to adjust the printer light calibration sets to match the lab you are using. You should work with your lab technician to set up the Lab Aim settings, the Steps adjustments, which is an incremental value, and the Density Increment adjustment, which is the amount of correction applied within each step. Usually, the Step and Density values will be identical, but this will be up to your lab and your preference.

Fairlight

Video I/O Offset

The two preferences found in this section let you offset overall video playback up to 7 frames earlier than your audio playback, to account for situations where image processing applied to your video output is causing delays that make the video out of sync with your audio. For example, let's say your video output is going through a video convertor that adds a 1 frame delay, and then connects to a video projector that adds another 1 frame of delay. You can set your Video Monitor Offset to 2 frames to compensate, so the audio/video sync is solid.

- **Video Monitor Offset:** This drop-down menu lets you choose an offset from 0 to 7 frames.
- **Apply Offset during Jog and Shuttle:** Turning this checkbox on ensures that the offset you choose is also applied when you use Jog and Shuttle to move through your program.

General Settings

The two preferences found in the General Settings section both let you customize the Loop Jog behavior that's currently available only on the Fairlight page. Choosing Timeline > Loop Jog enables a brief sample preview to be heard while scrubbing the playhead through the Timeline. This can make it easier to recognize bits of dialog or music as you're quickly scrubbing through tracks, in situations where you're trying to locate specific lines or music cues. It also enables this brief sample preview to loop endlessly when you hold the playhead on a frame, so you can pause while scrubbing and hear (by default) the current 80 ms prior to the playhead as it loops. A pair of settings let you customize this behavior.

- **Loop Jog Alignment:** Three options let you choose whether you loop audio Pre the position of the playhead, Centered on the playhead, or Post the position of the playhead.
- **Loop Jog Width:** A field lets you choose how many milliseconds of audio to loop when Loop Jog is enabled. How many milliseconds of audio corresponds to one frame depends on the frame rate of the video. For example, at a frame rate of 25 fps, there are $1000/25 = 40$ ms per frame, so the default value of 80 ms equals two frames of looping.
- **Enable auto patching:** Checking this box routes the first of your system audio inputs to the track that has "arm for record" on.
- **Mixer follows selected track:** Checking this box ensures that the selected track appears focused and left-most in the Mixer pane.
- **Include mixer events in Undo history:** Checking this box ensures that you can undo mixer events (such as edits to panning or track mute state).

Automation

The two preferences found in the Automation section let you customize the Glide Time between Automation events and whether or not Automation events are included when recalling a preset or when copying and pasting.

- **Glide Time:** Enter a value in milliseconds to customize the Glide Time for automation.
- **Write on Preset or Clipboard Paste:** Checking this box ensures that Automation events are written to the track when recalling a track preset or copying and pasting. Note that when enabled, the information written is still dependent on the status of what master automation is enabled or disabled. For example, if plugin automation is disabled, no plugin automation will be written.

Playback Settings

These preferences let you improve realtime performance in DaVinci Resolve by disabling specific UI features and optimizing the quality of some operations.

- **Hide UI overlays:** When using a single GPU for both display and CUDA, OpenCL, or Metal processing, or if your display GPU is underpowered, or if you lack the PCIe bandwidth required for the currently specified resolution or frame rate, you may be able to improve real time performance by turning this option on. When enabled, onscreen controls such as the cursor, Power Window outlines, and split-screen views are disabled and hidden during playback. When playback is paused, all onscreen controls reappear.
- **Minimize interface updates during playback:** When enabled, gives priority to real time performance during playback by reducing user-interface updates. This is helpful when you're creating complex grades on systems with low processing power, or when working on projects at high resolutions.
- **Performance Mode Automatic/Manual:** A trio of radio buttons let you choose between Automatic (default) and Manual (user selectable) behaviors when you turn on Performance Mode in DaVinci Resolve, or you can turn Performance Mode Off altogether. Set to Automatic, Performance mode automatically optimizes a variety of operations in a bid to balance performance with the necessary level of image quality, for fast onscreen performance while always maintaining the highest level of quality for video output. Set to Manual, there are three different settings you can choose to disable for instances where a particular performance tradeoff Resolve is making results in an undesirably noticeable reduction in image quality in Performance Mode:

Optimized Sizing: Relates to how image resizing is handled.

Optimized Decode Quality: Relates to how clip resolution vs. timeline resolution is handled.

Optimized Image Processing: Relates to how image processing operations are handled.

Control Panels

The parameters in this panel let you customize the functionality of the DaVinci Control panels.

Panel Sensitivity

Lets you choose the orientation of red on the trackballs, how sensitive trackballs and rings are, and how sensitive the qualifier knobs are.

- **Classic DaVinci trackball alignment:** When enabled, this checkbox sets all color balance controls in DaVinci Resolve to the traditional orientation they've always used, which is close to, but not exactly the same as, the vectorscope alignment of hues. When disabled, the alignment of color balance controls is exactly the same as the vectorscope alignment of hues, which is similar to how other color grading applications work. You should choose the mode you're most familiar with.

- **Grading style:** Controls the orientation of the trackballs relative to the corrections they make. There are two options:
DaVinci: Most users will be familiar with the standard DaVinci controls as this mimics the vectorscope (how closely depends on the Classic DaVinci trackball alignment setting).
Rank: The Rank settings are somewhat different, so this option is for users who are familiar with color controls that the Rank control system offered. In this mode, the orientation of red and green are reversed.
- **Lift RGB balance:** Controls how quickly adjustments made to the Lift trackball (on the left) will adjust the Lift Color Balance parameters in the Color page. This setting affects third-party panels.
- **Lift master:** Controls how quickly adjustments made to the Lift ring (surrounding the leftmost trackball) will adjust the Lift Contrast parameter in the Color page. This setting affects third-party panels.
- **Gamma RGB balance:** Controls how quickly adjustments made to the Gamma trackball (second from the left) will adjust the Gamma Color Balance parameters in the Color page. This setting affects third-party panels.
- **Gamma master:** Controls how quickly adjustments made to the Gamma ring (surrounding the second trackball from the left) adjust the Gamma parameter in the Color page. This setting affects third-party panels.
- **Gain RGB balance:** Controls how quickly adjustments made to the Gain trackball (third from the left) will adjust the Gain Color Balance parameters in the Color page. This setting affects third-party panels.
- **Gain master:** Controls how quickly adjustments made to the Gain ring (surrounding the third trackball from the left) will adjust the Gain Contrast parameter in the Color page. This setting affects third-party panels.
- **Cursor offset:** Controls how quickly adjustments made to the fourth trackball affect the cursor, window position, log-mode offset, and other controls that can be manipulated via this trackball.
- **Cursor master:** Controls how quickly adjustments made to the fourth ring affect log-mode master offset, and other controls that can be manipulated via this ring.
- **Hue/Saturation/Luminance qualifier:** Controls the sensitivity of the HSL panel control knobs.
- **Jog:** Controls the sensitivity of the jog wheel.
- **Shuttle:** Controls the sensitivity of the shuttle dial.

Display Settings

Lets you adjust the display of your Blackmagic Design control panels.

- **LCD brightness:** Controls the overall brightness of the DaVinci control panel displays.
- **Key backlighting:** Depending on which control panel you have selected, two controls let you choose LCD Brightness and Key backlighting of the DaVinci Resolve Mini panel, or three controls let you adjust the color balance of the lit buttons of the DaVinci Resolve Advanced control panel (the default is red).

Metadata

The metadata panel lets you create custom sets of metadata parameters that will be exposed in the Metadata Editor.

For more information on using this panel, see *Chapter 19, "Using Clip Metadata."*

Keyboard Customization

Choosing DaVinci Resolve > Keyboard Customization opens the standalone Keyboard Customization window. This window lets you choose which set of keyboard shortcuts you want to use, discover which keyboard shortcuts are available, or create your own custom keyboard mappings that more closely adhere to the way you like to work, in whichever pages you find yourself working.



The Keyboard Customization window

Choosing Keyboard Shortcut Emulation Presets

Using a drop-down at the top right of this menu, you can choose the default DaVinci Resolve set or any one of the other sets that attempt to mimic other NLEs you might be more familiar with. Please note that keyboard shortcuts can only be remapped to commands that functionally exist within DaVinci Resolve, so if a specific feature of another NLE does not have an equivalent in DaVinci Resolve, that key shortcut may not be mapped in the same way. Fortunately, the editorial feature set of DaVinci Resolve broadly overlaps with common features in other NLEs, so you should find that most features you're used to have a functional equivalent.

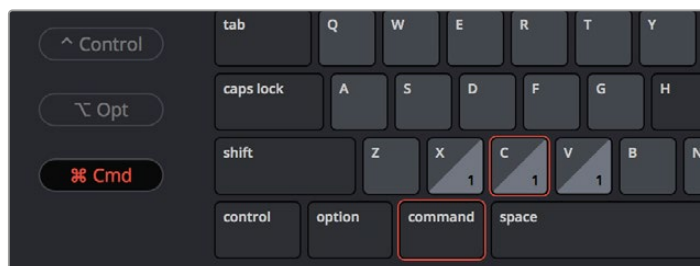


You can choose one of the preset keyboard mappings to emulate another NLE you're familiar with or the default DaVinci Resolve keyboard mapping.

You also have the ability to create your own custom sets of keyboard shortcuts. The Commands list below shows a hierarchical list of commands organized by the menu they appear within. This list lets you select individual commands to remap and can be searched if you're having a hard time finding what you're looking for. This is described in more detail later in this section.

Viewing Commands Assigned to Specific Key Combinations

To see what command a particular key of the keyboard is mapped to, you can click any combination of modifier and other keys on the virtual keyboard at the top of this window. The currently selected keys reveal how they're mapped in the "Active Key" list below.



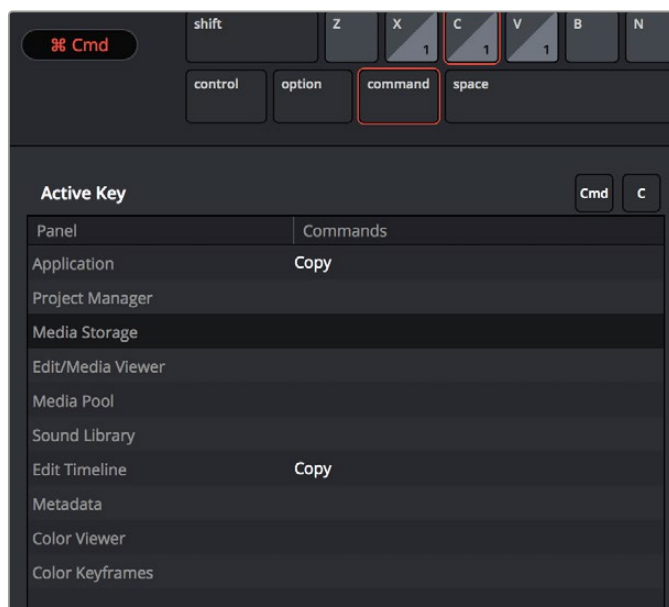
Selecting keys and modifiers on the virtual keyboard displays their command mapping below

TIP: Starting in DaVinci Resolve 15.2, commands can have multiple keys or key combinations assigned to them, and number keys on the numeric keypad of an extended keyboard can be assigned independently from keys at the top of a keyboard.

Panel-Specific Keyboard Mappings

When customizing keyboard shortcuts, they can be assigned to the "Application" so that shortcut works identically within every part of the DaVinci Resolve UI that's applicable, or you can map a particular keyboard shortcut to do a particular command within a specific panel.

Panel-specific keyboard shortcuts let you use a single key to do different things depending on which panel has focus; for example, one key can do different things in the Media Pool, the Edit Timeline, the Metadata Editor, and the Sound Library, to give a few Edit Page examples. This provides enormous flexibility, but if you go this route, you need to be aware of which panel has focus. Fortunately, starting in DaVinci Resolve 15.2, focus is indicated by a colored highlight at the top of each panel.



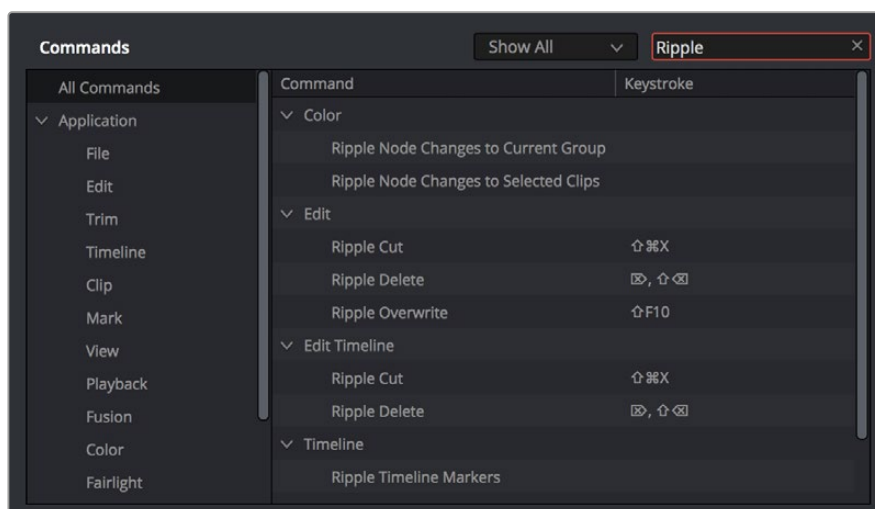
Keyboard shortcuts can now be mapped to specific panels so that different panels can use the same shortcut to accomplish different things

Searching for Keyboard Shortcuts

Whether you're looking to see what keyboard shortcuts are available or looking for a particular command you want to customize, a Search field above the Commands list is available for searching whichever group of commands you want (including All Commands).

To search for specific keyboard shortcuts:

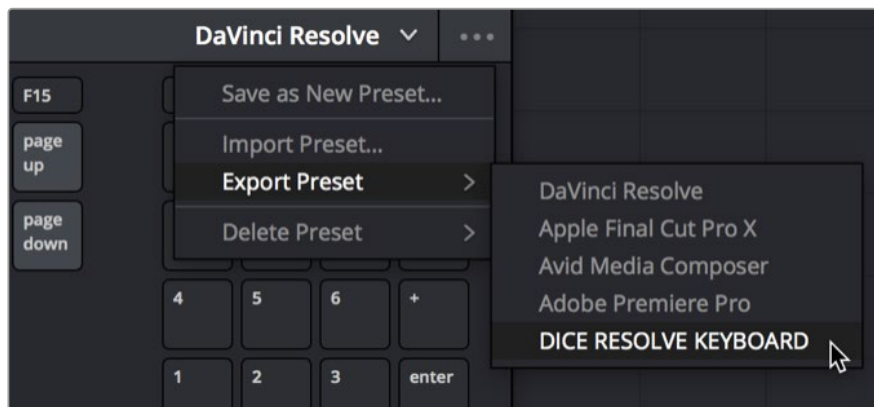
- 1 Choose DaVinci Resolve > Keyboard Customization.
- 2 Choose a command group from the Commands list to search within. If you want to search all of DaVinci Resolve, choose "All Commands."
- 3 Type a term into the Search field, and the Command/Keystroke list will update to show whatever commands match the search criteria you've entered.



Selecting "All Commands" and searching for every keyboard shortcut corresponding to the word "ripple"

Managing Keyboard Mappings

DaVinci Resolve provides the following methods for creating and managing keyboard mappings in the Option menu of the Keyboard Customization menu:



The Option menu of the Keyboard Customization window lets you export, import, and delete keyboard mappings

- **To create a new keyboard mapping:** Choose a keyboard mapping from the drop-down to use as your starting point, choose Save As New Preset from the Keyboard Customization Option menu, then enter a preset name in the dialog, and click OK. That preset will now appear in the preset drop-down menu.
- **To export a keyboard shortcut file for use by another DaVinci Resolve workstation:** Choose a preset from the Export Preset submenu of the Keyboard Customization Option menu, then choose a name and a location for the new file, and click Save.
- **To import a keyboard shortcut file:** Choose Import Preset from the Keyboard Customization Option menu, choose a DaVinci Resolve keyboard shortcut file, and click Open.
- **To delete a keyboard mapping:** Choose a keyboard mapping preset you want to delete, then click the trash can button.

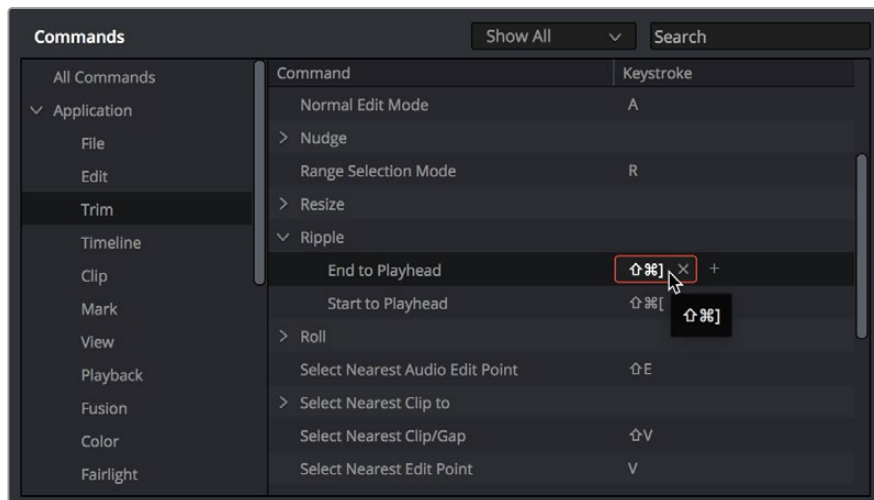
Remapping a Command to One or More Keys

Changing the keyboard mapping for any given command is easy. You can even map a single command to multiple keys, if necessary. In DaVinci Resolve, actions can be application-wide or specific to Media Pool, or Timeline, or other panels. The right column in the key customization dialog shows application-level and panel-level actions. When a panel is in focus, hotkeys prioritize panel-local actions. This allows you to reuse the same key shortcut in the application level and within each panel at the same time.

To change the keyboard shortcut for a particular command:

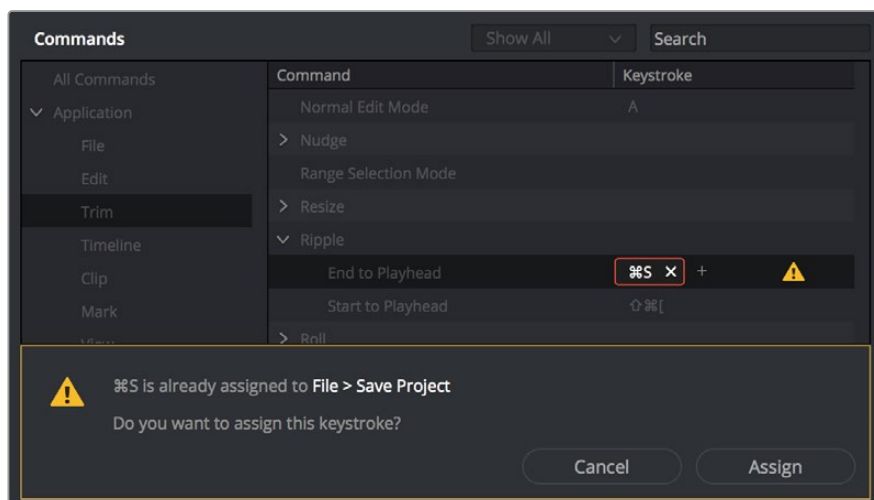
- 1 Find the command you want to remap in the Commands list by selecting a category. If necessary, use the Search field. Whether a command is mapped generally to the entire application or specifically to a particular panel depends on what you've selected from the list.
 - a) If you want the keyboard character you plan to map to work application-wide, choose a menu name from underneath the Application category of the Commands list. Each menu shows all commands associated with it and can be individually searched.
 - b) If you want the keyboard character you plan to map to this command to be specific to a particular panel, then choose one from the Panels category underneath. Each panel shows all commands associated with it and can be individually searched.

- 2 Click within the Keystroke column of the list, to the right of the command, and when a selection appears type a new character using any combination of modifier keys you like.



Clicking to select a keyboard shortcut you want to modify

Please note that if you remap a key that was already assigned to another command, you'll see a warning that the key you're about to remap is already assigned to another command, giving you a chance to cancel and change key assignments if you like.



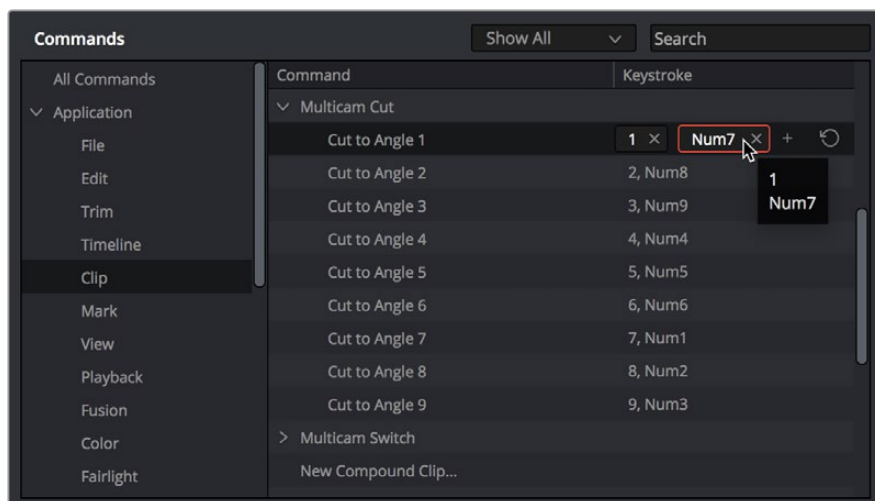
The warning you see if you try to map the same key to multiple commands

You can override the warning and make the assignment, but having the same character or combination applied to multiple commands can cause problems, so a warning badge appears next to affected commands. Clicking on this badge makes it easy to see where the duplicate is by highlighting the keys on the keyboard, so you can remap one or the other command as necessary.

To resolve a shortcut conflict:

- Click the yellow warning icon next to the action. This shows all actions for that hotkey in the left panel.
- Click on the other conflicting actions at the same level to reveal them in the right pane.
- Change or unset these values so as not to conflict with your new key assignment.

- 3 (Optional) You also have the option of assigning multiple keyboard shortcuts to a single command. For example, if you want to use keys on the numeric keypad of an extended keyboard in addition to other keys for a particular command, you can now set this up by clicking the “plus” button to the right of a currently assigned keyboard shortcut. This makes another highlight appear, within which you can type any secondary character or combination you like to make the additional assignment. You can do this as many times as you like. When you’re done, all keyboard shortcuts applied to that command appear, separated by commas.



You can map multiple keys to the same command, if necessary

- 4 When you’re finished changing keyboard shortcuts, click the Save button at the bottom right of the Keyboard Mapping list, and then click Close to close the window.

For example, if you set ‘Option-G’ to:

- a) The Media Pool-specific Clip Attributes,
- b) The application-wide Mark > Add Flag > Green to ‘Option-G’.

When you are focused on the Media Pool, you cannot add green flags with a hotkey. You will need to manually add them via the Mark menu.

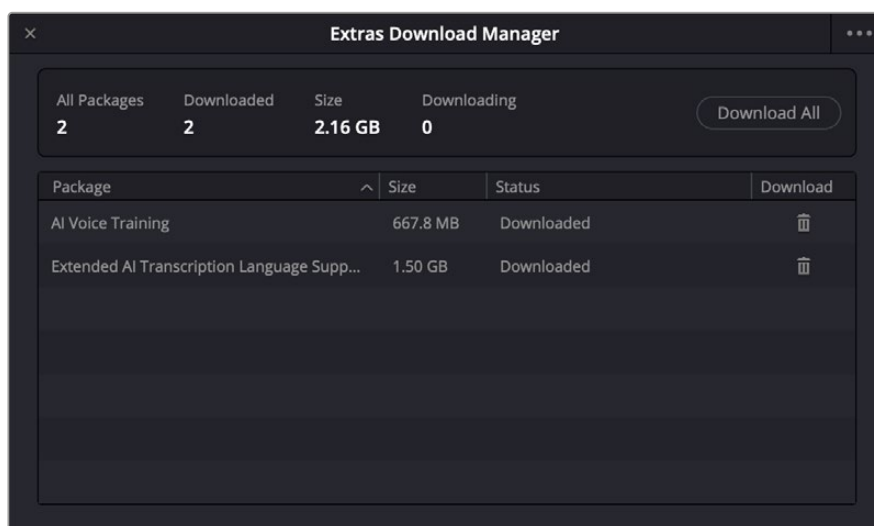
In addition, the application-wide Color > Nodes > Add serial node with polygon power window also has the same hotkey (Option-G), so action b will cause the the key customization dialog to show a warning with the conflicting action name and display an icon on both actions.

If you save this state as a preset (with conflicts), DaVinci Resolve will still try to parse your shortcuts logically. For example, on the Edit and Fairlight timelines, Option-G adds a green flag (as color node actions are not applicable). But in the Color page, Option-G can refer to both actions and the user needs to resolve the conflict to make the action work correctly.

DaVinci Resolve Extras Download Manager

As DaVinci Resolve evolves to incorporate more AI-based models, there is a tradeoff in application file size. These AI models tend to be large datasets that not all users will want or need to use. To help with this decision, DaVinci Resolve has the Extras Download Manager, allowing you to pick and choose which optional functionality you want to add to DaVinci Resolve.

The Extras Download Manager can be found at DaVinci Resolve > Extras Download Manager.



The Extras Download Manager

To use the Extras Download Manager, simply view the packages available and select download. You can remove a package in the same interface by clicking on the trashcan icon next to the package name. Downloads will happen in the background while you continue to work. From time to time these packages will be updated, and you will be notified here if your current package is out of date.

Currently, the Download Manager contains packages for AI Voice Training and Extended AI Transcription Support Languages.